Stakeholder Engagement & Communication Framework

CASE STUDY MATRIX & ACTION PLAN | FORWARD-DEPLOYED ENGINEER PROGRAM

KAVYA'S AXIOM (PROGRAM LEAD SYNTHESIS)

"The best FDEs are not the ones who only understand systems. They are the ones who understand people, business problems, ambiguity, and change."

1. Comprehensive Stakeholder Engagement Plan

Stakeholder / Role	Classification	Power / Interest	Mendelow Matrix	Identified Project Risks	Engagement & Mitigation Strategy
Store Managers Frontline End-Users	EXTERNAL PRIMARY	Power: LOW Interest: HIGH	**Keep Informed** (High collective adoption impact)	**Operational Failure & Rejection:** Active system avoidance due to perceived complexity and zero early-stage consultation. Endangers total project ROI.	**Proactive User-Empathy Mapping:** Execute workshops in **Week 1** instead of Week 4. Capture localized UI preferences, short summaries, and multilingual requirements early.
Client VP of Operations Executive Sponsor	EXTERNAL PRIMARY	Power: HIGH Interest: HIGH	**Key Player** (Maintains contract authority)	**Institutional Escalation:** Severe breakdown of trust leading to critical corporate escalations 48 hours prior to high-stakes demos, threatening contract value.	**Business Translation Layer:** Shield executives from technical jargon. Pass all engineering milestones through an outcome-driven communication filter.
Client Operations Manager Day-to-Day Product Lead	EXTERNAL PRIMARY	Power: HIGH Interest: HIGH	**Key Player** (Drives timeline pressures)	**Timeline Compression:** Unrealistic demands (e.g., 2-week turnaround) that force team silence, bypassing crucial infrastructure validation steps.	**Data-Backed Scope Negotiation:** Proactively present dependency roadmaps. Counter unrealistic timelines with structured, phased rollout schedules.
XYZ Engineering Team Internal Technical Crew	INTERNAL PRIMARY	Power: HIGH Interest: HIGH	**Key Player** (Executes core delivery)	**Dysfunction & Defensiveness:** Anxiety and finger-pointing under pressure. Fragile alignment causes retreat into uncommunicative silence and blame-shifting.	**Soft-Skills Integration:** Build a cross-functional translation layer. Insulate development workflows from volatile client dynamics via clear requirement processing.
Case Study Author Forward-Deployed Engineer	INTERNAL PRIMARY	Power: MED Interest: HIGH	**Key Player** (Bridges code & consulting)	**Imposter Syndrome & Delay:** Fear of criticism causing hesitation in sharing raw	**Psychological Safety Building:** Normalize rapid prototyping and early-stage feedback sharing. Prioritize

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				ticket categorization drafts, directly lowering team velocity.	proactive communication as highly as pure technical design.

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TARGETED COMMUNICATION GRID | EXECUTION PHASE

2. Actionable Project Communication Plan

Target Stakeholder	Communication Objective	Core Message Content (The Jargon Filter applied)	Channel / Method	Frequency	Depth	Owner
Store Managers	Overcome system friction, build trust, and ensure product adoption.	✔ **Business Outcome Focused:** "This system setup guarantees you can securely access localized inventory reports within 4 seconds via basic text input." ✕ **Raw Jargon Removed:** Context injection schemas, multi-vector embeddings, latency indexing.	Interactive Empathy Workshops, Hands-on UAT feedback loops	Weekly (Inception & Rollout)	Functional / Usability	FDE (Self)
Client VP of Operations	Maintain executive alignment and eliminate surprise escalation triggers.	✔ **Strategic Alignment:** High-level roadmap metrics highlighting verification milestones, systemic stability metrics, and realized business ROI.	Executive Steering Dashboards, Bi-weekly Pilot Briefings	Bi-weekly (and 48h before demos)	Strategic / High-Level	FDE Lead / Account Exec
Client Operations Manager	Manage delivery expectations and protect pipeline architecture.	✔ **Phased Rollout Proposal:** "To secure absolute data pipeline stability, we are deploying a limited static pilot in 2 weeks, followed by full real-time ingestion in Week 4."	Timeline Dependency Charts, Status Sync Meetings	Weekly Status Alignment	Operational Dependencies	FDE
XYZ Engineering Team	Maintain architecture velocity, clarify features, and remove blame culture.	✔ **Actionable Engineering Metrics:** De-escalated and translated operational user stories, clear schema boundaries, and structured sprint backlogs.	Daily Standups, Sprint Planning, Retrospectives	Daily	Technical Deep-Dive	FDE Lead / Tech Lead
Case Study Author (FDE)	Break information bottlenecks and conquer imposter syndrome hurdles.	✔ **Rapid Prototyping Ideas:** Early-stage, unpolished ticket categorization draft logic, processing speed risk flags, and exploratory schema feedback.	1-on-1 Syncs, Shared internal drafts workspace	Continuous / Ad-hoc	Raw Draft / Experimental	FDE (Self)